

Will Baker 2026
Design Portfolio

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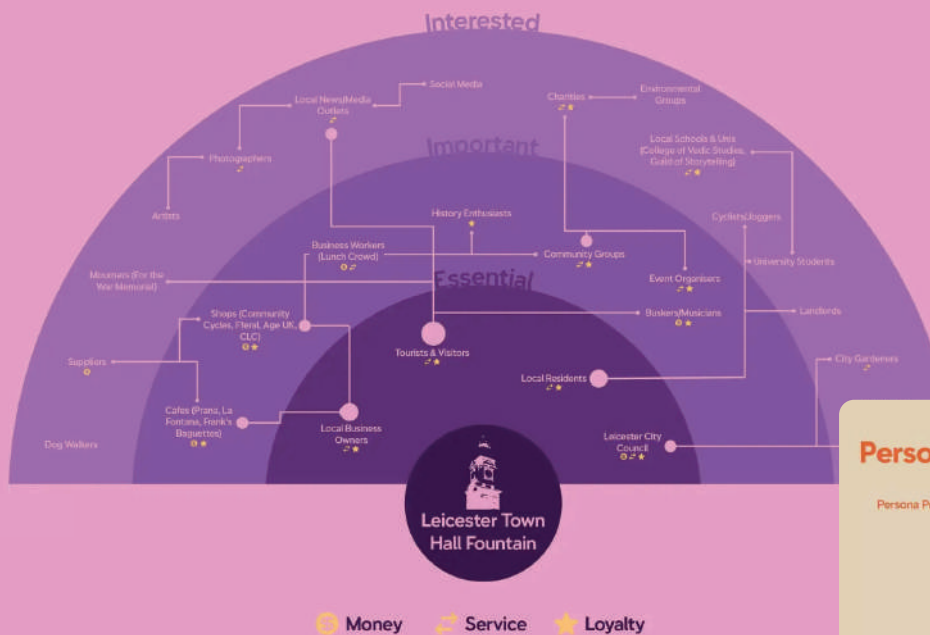
Portfolio

The Fountain

This project repositioned Leicester's Town Hall Fountain as a more inviting public space. Research and persona mapping led to two identity routes: one using the fountain's gargoyles, the other a clean monogram with pastel colours. Both explored logos, typography, colour and animation to present the fountain as a place to pause and connect.



Stakeholder Map



Will Baker - F427608

I mapped the main groups around the fountain, workers, residents, visitors and the council, each with different needs. To make this more tangible, I created personas showing everyday behaviours, like a worker seeking calm or a resident wanting a welcoming place to meet friends, which guided inclusive design choices.

Persona 1

Persona Profile



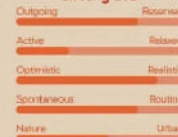
Jake, B.

- bio**
- 31 Years Old
 - Civil Engineer for the Council
 - Lives on Green Rd, Leicester
 - Works in the city centre
 - Relationship with Georgia M.

expectations

Jake wants the Town Hall Fountain to feel like a proper public space, not just a cut-through or leftover bit of green. He's looking for somewhere to sit, sketch, or take a break without feeling rushed. The design should fit with the character of the Town Hall and include greenery that feels part of the space. He values good seating, clear paths, and signs that the space is looked after. A few small events or displays would be a bonus, but more than anything, he wants it to feel like a place people actually use and enjoy.

analysis



Leicester Town Hall Fountain

frustrations

Jake finds it hard to relax in Leicester's city centre. Most public spaces feel busy, noisy, and not designed for people to actually spend time in. There aren't many quiet places to sit, and when there are, the seating is uncomfortable or awkwardly placed. He gets frustrated seeing the Town Hall's historic building surrounded by clutter or ignored altogether. As someone who cares about design, he notices when materials feel cheap or when the space feels disconnected from the people using it. He also thinks the area could do more to bring people together or highlight what makes Leicester unique.

interests

- Architecture
- Sketching
- Photography
- Culture
- Cats
- Nature
- Design
- Exploration
- Reading

Persona 2

Persona Profile



Margaret, M.

- bio**
- Retired Schoolteacher
 - Lives on Clarendon Park Road
 - Enjoys visiting the city centre
 - Meets friends for tea often
 - Values community and quiet

expectations

Margaret wants the Leicester Town Hall Fountain area to be a calm, friendly space that encourages connection and relaxation. She expects it to feel like a natural part of the city's heart, a place where people of all ages can come together, whether for casual chats with friends or simply to watch the world go by. She hopes the space will foster a sense of community pride by reflecting Leicester's unique character and history, making it more than just a patch of green. Small-scale cultural activities or markets that celebrate local culture would add to the space's appeal without overwhelming the peaceful atmosphere. Above all, Margaret wants the space to feel welcoming and inclusive, where she can comfortably spend time feeling part of something bigger.

analysis



Leicester Town Hall Fountain

frustrations

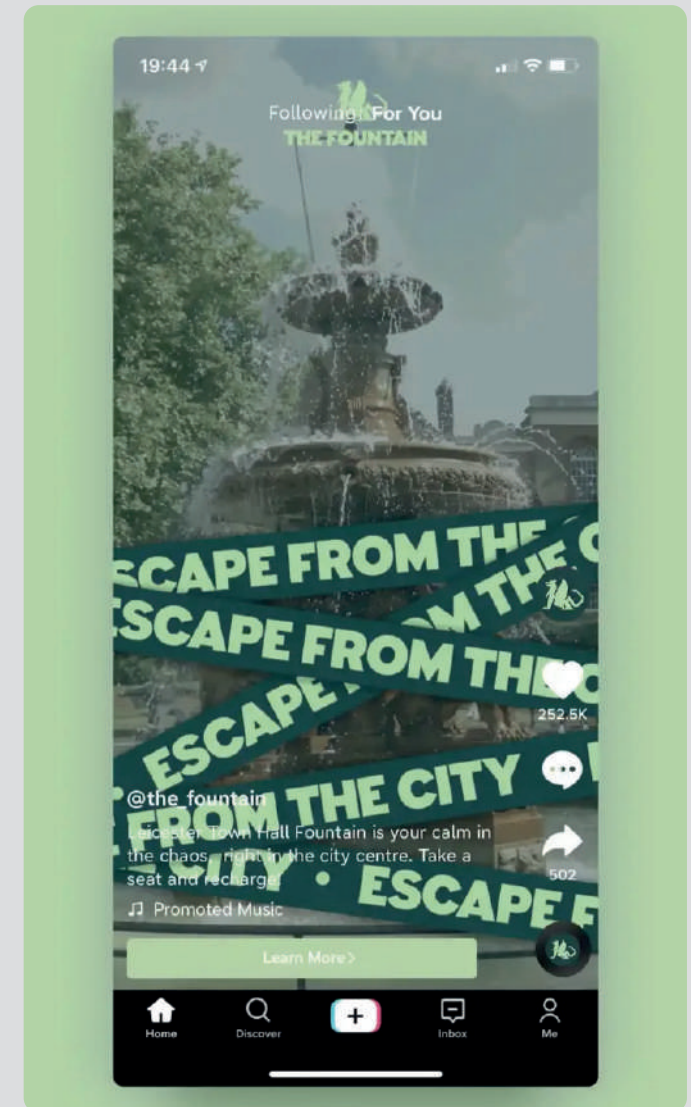
Margaret feels that Leicester as a city can sometimes be overwhelming, too noisy and rushed, making it hard for her to find quiet moments or feel at ease. She's frustrated that many city spaces don't always feel inclusive or inviting for older people like her, which can leave her feeling overlooked. Navigating crowded streets and busy public areas is often tiring, and she wishes the city offered more places where she could just slow down and enjoy herself without the pressure to be constantly on the move. Margaret also finds that many public spaces don't celebrate the city's community spirit in ways that resonate with her generation.

interests

- Reflection
- Leid
- Waking
- Chasing
- Relaxing
- Friends
- Warm
- Gentle
- Green Spaces



The first concept simplifies the fountain's gargoyles into clean, small-scale logos suitable for print and digital. It uses bold contrasts to give the heritage imagery a modern edge, keeping the identity recognisable and flexible for various applications.

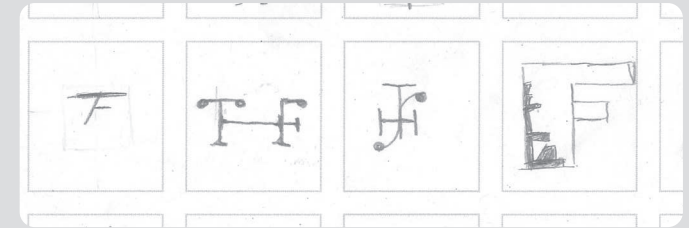




F
the fountain



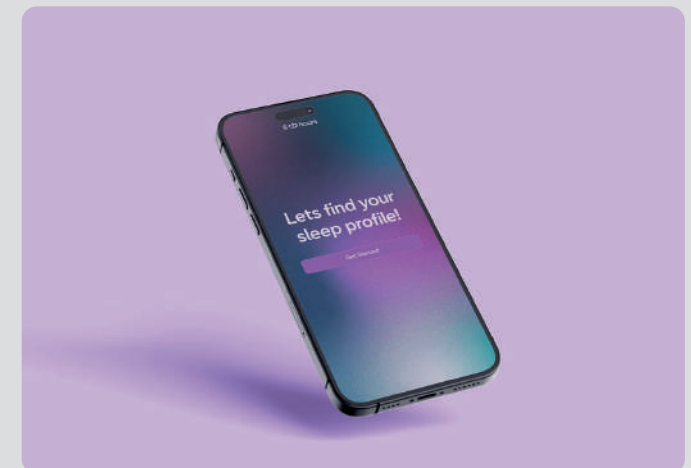
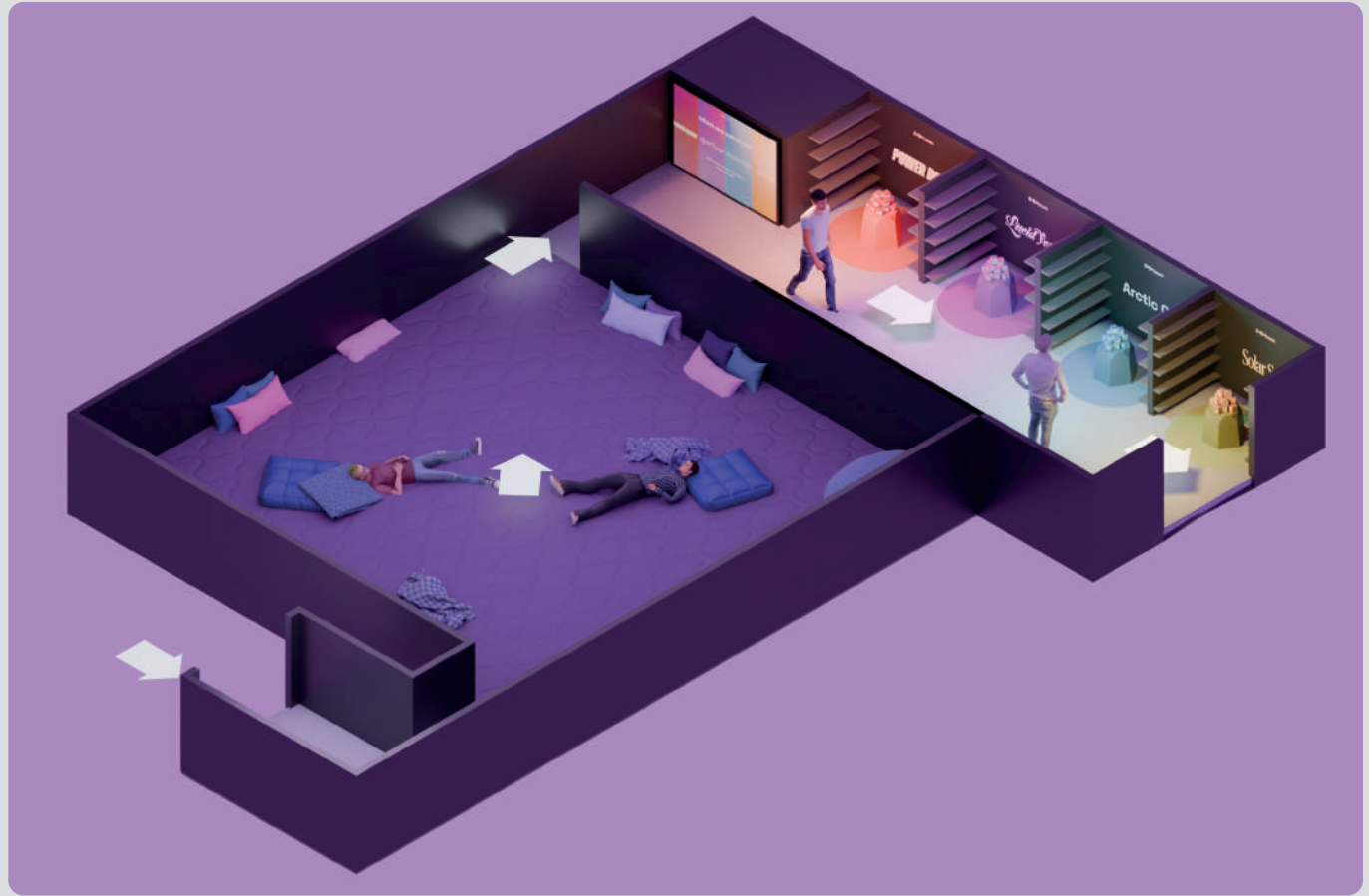
The second concept presents a modern monogram with a soft pastel palette for a lighter, approachable feel. The logo is clear at small sizes, with minimal typography and colour to create a calm, inclusive brand presence for the fountain as a welcoming public space.



8 Hours

8 Hours is a fictional sleep wellness brand I created as the foundation for an immersive university experience tackling the UK's sleep deprivation crisis. With over 75% of adults getting less than the recommended 8 hours, the project targets the 18–24 demographic.

The experience takes place during Freshers Week, where students lie on a soft mattress floor and watch an introductory animation on a ceiling-mounted LED screen. They then take a group quiz via a companion app, answering questions that range from playful to serious about their sleeping habits. At the end, they're matched to one of four personalised herbal patch variants, Power Down, Lucid Voyage, Arctic Chill, or Solar Sync.



Persons 1

8 Hours Experience

The Sport Player

Leo, 20

who

Leo is a first-team rugby player. His life is a constant oscillation between peak physical exertion and social chaos. He's up at 5:30 AM for drills but stays at the Student Union until 5:00 AM on Wednesday nights. He's physically exhausted but often too "wired" from adrenaline or pre-workout supplements to actually drift off.

frustrations

He finishes a high-stakes match at 9:00 PM, his body is exhausted, but his brain is buzzing from the game and the post-match celebrations. He lays in bed with a racing heart, unable to "drop off."

Because his wake-up times vary wildly (5:00 AM for training, 10:00 AM for recovery days), he never feels truly rested.

expectations

He wants to learn about Active Recovery. He's looking for the "8 Hours" experience to teach him that sleep is a legal performance enhancer. He wants to leave knowing how to lower his core temperature or heart rate quickly after a late-night game to help enter the state of recovery quicker.

personality

Extraversion

Routine-Driven

Task-Dependency

Stress Level

interests

Persona 2

8 Hours Experience

The Working Student

Maya, 21

who

Maya works 16 hours a week at a local coffee shop to cover her rent. Between shifts, studio time, and trying to maintain a semblance of a social life, sleep is her lowest priority. She treats sleep as a luxury she can't afford, often doing her laundry at midnight and answering emails at 2:00 AM.

personality

Extraversion	
Routine-Driven	
Tact-Dependency	
Stress Level	

frustrations

Since her day is dictated by her boss and her tutors, nighttime is the only time she feels "in control." She scrolls on her phone for two hours simply because it's her only "me-time," even though she's exhausted.

After a shift at a coffee shop or retail store, the "ping" of a notification or the hum of a refrigerator feels magnified. She can't find "quiet" even in a dark room.

expectations

She hopes to learn Sleep Efficiency. She wants the experience to prove that a structured "8 Hours" routine actually buys her more time the next day by increasing her focus. She'll be the most interested in the customized products a personalized kit that makes the wind-down feel like a luxury ritual rather than a chore.

interests

Design	Budget	Art
Coffee	Thrifting	Travel
Fashion	Friends	

Personas 3

8 Hours Experience

The Academic Weapon



Ethan, 19

who

Ethan is a perfectionist. He is a regular at the 24-hour library. He fuels his 14-hour study sessions with energy drinks and focus playlists. He considers an all-nighter a badge of honor, even though he knows his retention is dropping. His natural circadian rhythm is non-existent and rarely sees the sun.

frustrations

He spends 12+ hours looking at screens. Even when he closes his eyes, he can see the glow of his laptop.

He uses caffeine to stay up and then considers using pills to get down. He hates the groggy feeling of sleep meds but doesn't know how else to stop his brain from revising Law cases at 3:00 AM.

expectations

He wants to learn the Science of Memory Consolidation. He needs the 8 Hours experience to explain why herbal remedies and blocking blue light will help him get a First-Class degree. He wants to leave with a Study/Sleep Schedule that treats rest as a cognitive tool.

personality

Extroversion

Routine-Driven

Tech-Dependency

Stress Level

interests

Library

Gaming

Data

Grades

Exams

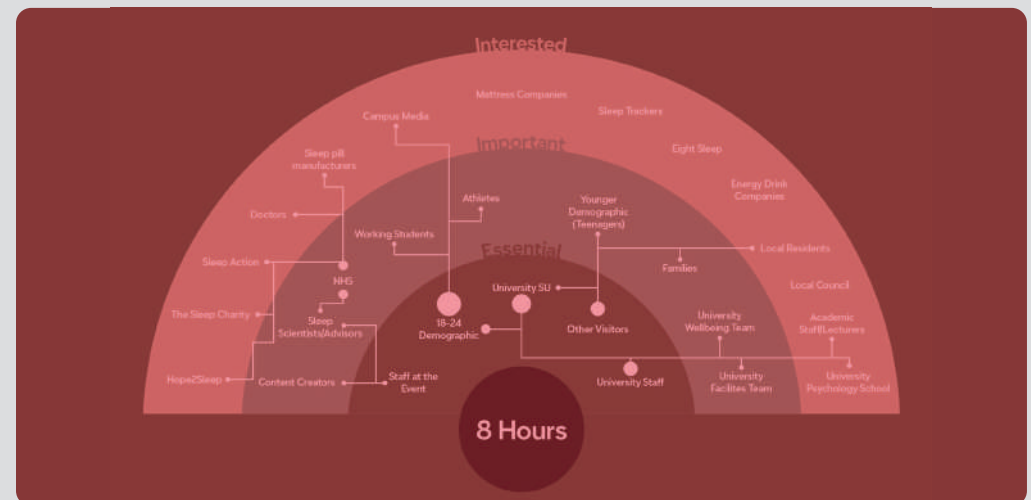
Focus

Energy Drinks

Law

The project started off by first gathering insight into my demographic. I conducted research into various different types of students (sporty/working/academic) and how they'd interact with my experience/products.

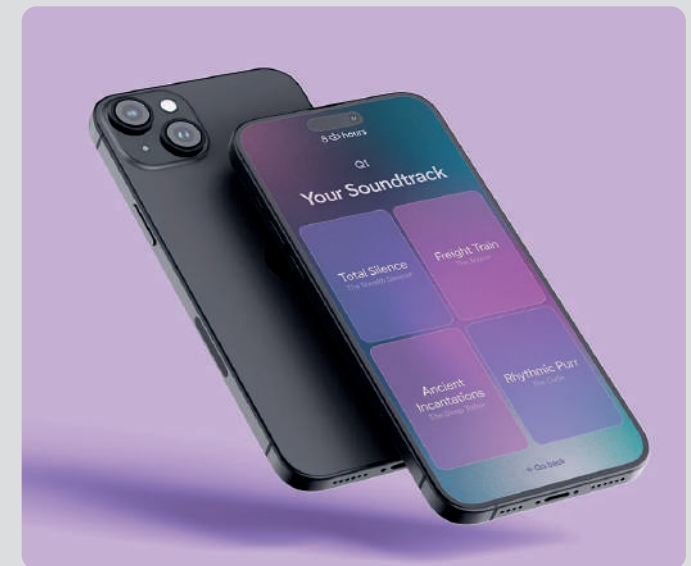
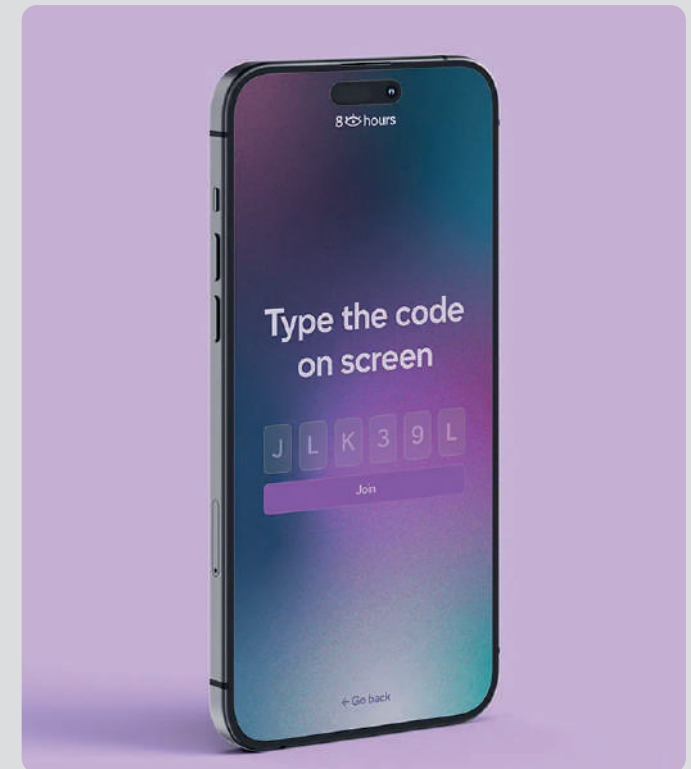
I also looked at different how different companies and stakeholders interact with the project (University staff, sleep professionals, NHS, etc).

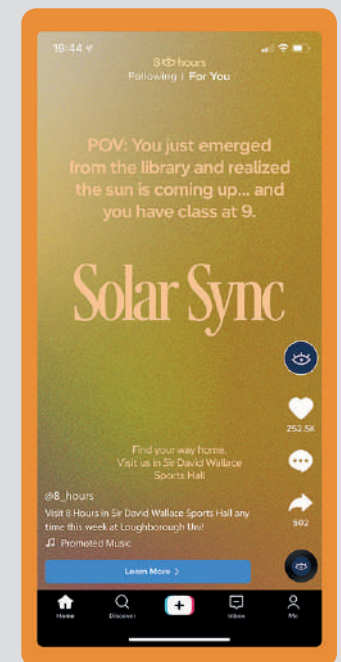
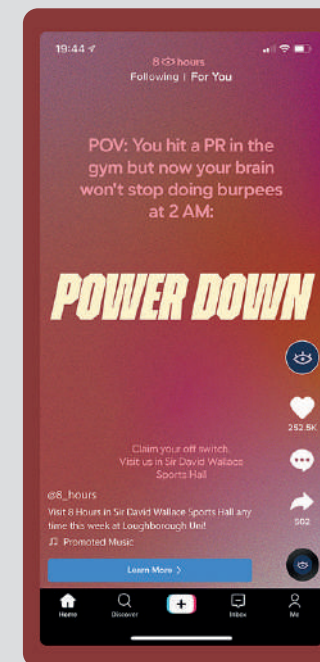
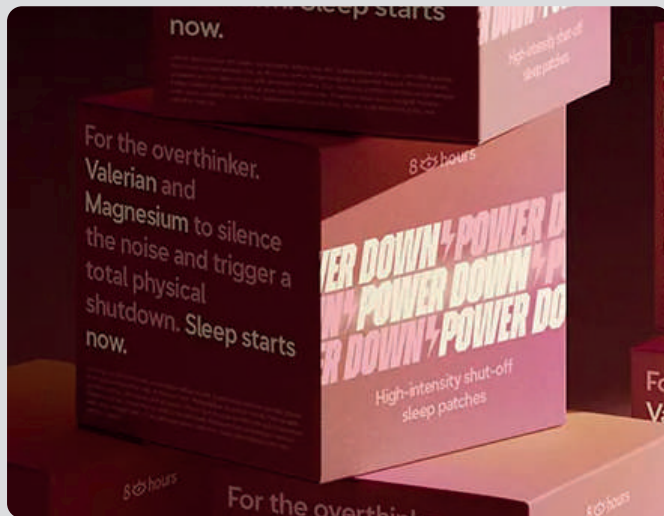
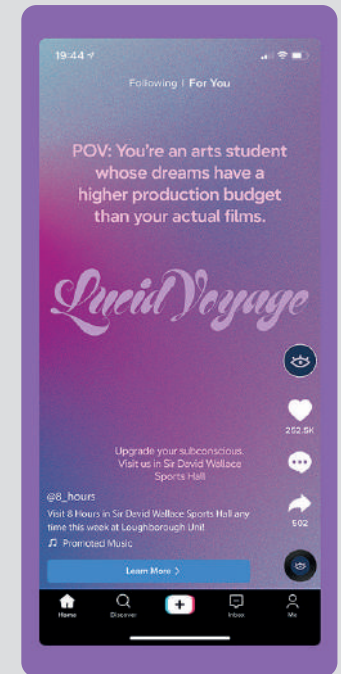
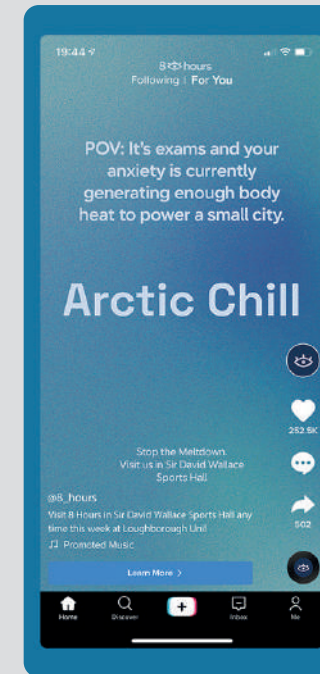


The logo for '8 hours' features a stylized white eye icon where the pupil is a dot and the iris is a circle. The number '8' is to the left of the eye, and the word 'hours' is to the right, all in a white, sans-serif font. The background is a gradient of purple and blue with a fine, grainy texture.

I then created some branding for my fictional company. This included a logo, an animated logo, type, copywriting, as well as art direction involving the use of colours and gradients within the use of products/promotional material etc.

I also created an introductory video that would play in my experience. You can watch it both in situ and on its own here: <https://willb.cc/project/8-hours>

A circular graphic with a dark blue to purple gradient background. The word 'sleep' is repeated in a white, sans-serif font, curving around the perimeter of the circle. In the center, the text 'OF PEOPLE DON'T GET ENOUGH' is written in a bold, white, sans-serif font.



Based on the visual identity, I also created the different products for the audience to take home, as well as a social media campaign to help generate traction and excitement.

Resonance

This project explores how design can make biodiversity loss feel more immediate and personal. It centres on a meditation-style app that uses woodland sounds and local species information to encourage mindfulness and reflection. By slowing down and noticing nature, users are introduced to biodiversity data in a way that feels calm and accessible. The app also connects people to volunteering opportunities, turning awareness into action and helping them see how their wellbeing links to the health of the environment.

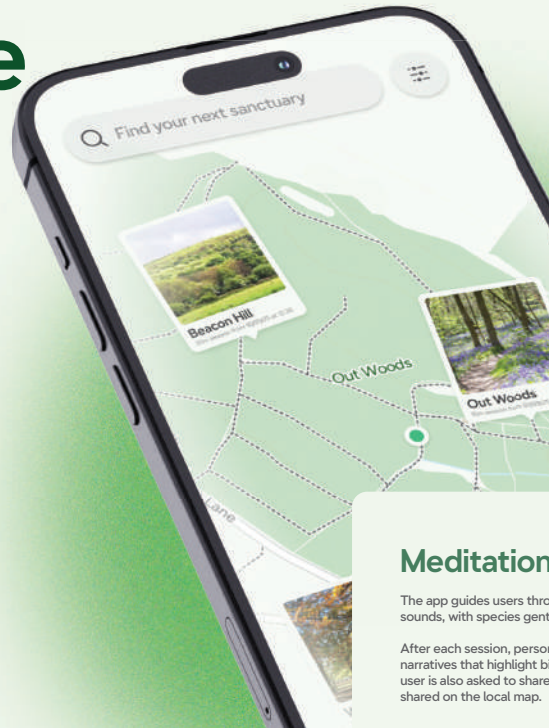
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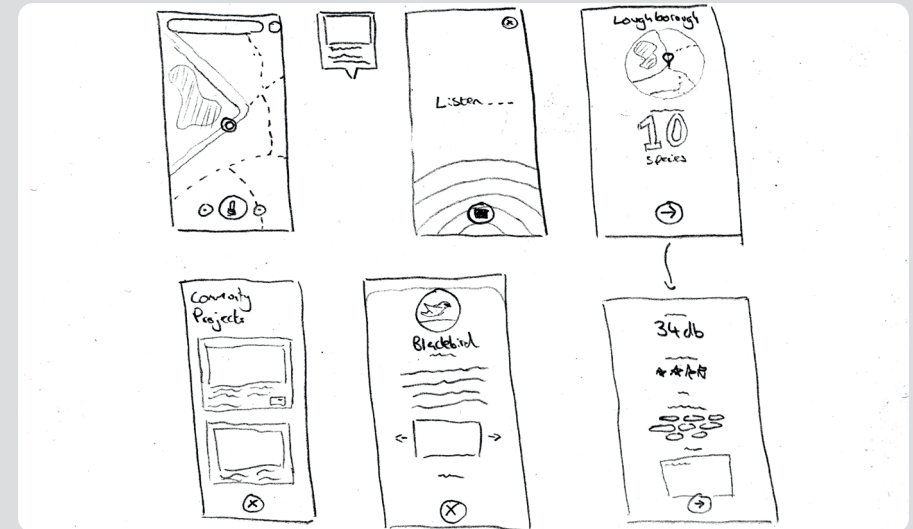
In collaboration with  The Woodland Trust

Resonance

This project was created to encourage environmental awareness by helping users slow down, listen, and reconnect with the natural world. With UK woodlands in decline and biodiversity falling sharply, the app turns complex statistics into something easier to understand and experience. It uses reflective interaction to inspire awareness and a sense of responsibility, showing how design can be both practical and purposeful. The main audience is women aged 18–30, a group more likely to face mental health challenges and benefit from mindfulness-based tools, though the app is open to anyone interested in nature and wellbeing.



Will Baker - F427608



Meditation Pages

The app guides users through calm breathing while listening to woodland sounds, with species gently appearing on-screen as they are identified.

After each session, personalised summaries turn statistics into engaging narratives that highlight biodiversity trends and encourage reflection. The user is also asked to share their thoughts of the location, which is then shared on the local map.

This project takes a product-focused UX/UI approach, designing an experience that feels calm, intuitive, and emotionally engaging. Design decisions prioritised clarity and ease of use, with a minimal interface, soft motion, and considered hierarchy to avoid overwhelming users.



Will Baker - F427608

Social Design - AC200

Information Pages

The app includes a species library where the user can find animals and plants they've encountered in the woodlands. These pages highlight the local biodiversity and encourage curiosity. To build on this awareness, the app also includes a volunteering section, connecting users directly to conservation projects and community initiatives.



Will Baker - F427608



Link to Figma App

<https://www.figma.com/proto/zoy1G8tRW7efl8TelegEpa/Social-Design>



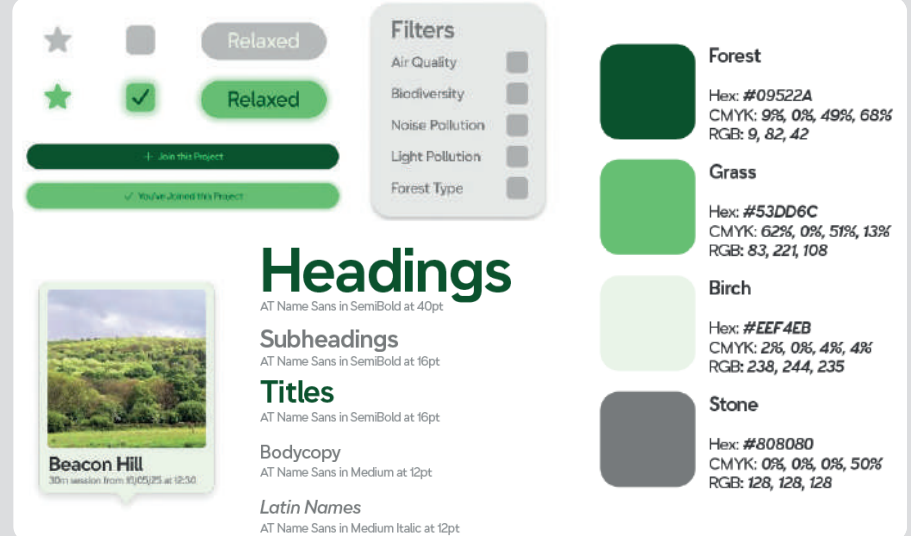
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Mr Mockups (2022). Free Laying iPhone 16 Pro Mockup. [online] Mockups Design. Available at: <https://mrmockup.com/free-laying-iphone-16-pro-mockup/> [Accessed 06 Nov 2025].

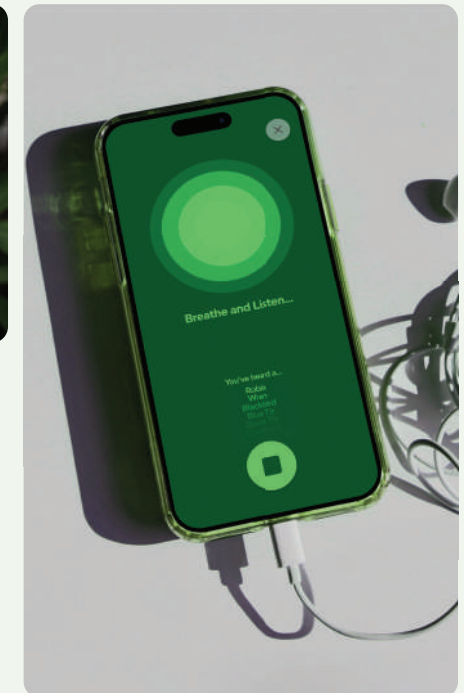
Mr Mockups (2022). Free iPhone 16 Pro in Hand PSD Mockup. [online] Mockups Design. Available at: <https://mrmockup.com/free-iphone-16-pro-in-hand-psd-mockup/> [Accessed 06 Nov 2025].

Will Baker - F427608



Features were intentionally revealed through interaction, encouraging exploration rather than instruction, and helping users build understanding at their own pace.

Local and personalised content was used to make the experience feel relevant and meaningful, while the overall flow guides users from quiet reflection toward deeper engagement and involvement.



Social Design - ACB140

Ardua

This project focused on modular typography, leading to the design of Ardua, a tall geometric display font created for Birmingham Design Festival. It draws on Bauhaus and Braun influences, with a variable crossbar and cutout details that make it flexible for motion and display use. The work included type experiments and specimen design, showing a clear balance of research and practical application.

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The typeface Ardua was developed by Will Baker in response to a brief posed by the 2025 Birmingham Design Festival. The brief was to create a modular display typeface to help promote the festival and its theme of "Play".

Inspiration was drawn from the festival's goal to celebrate the "local national and international design industry" (BOF, n) and the typeface certainly reflects this ambition with its imposing physical stature.

The font carries a cap height in an almost monospaced package, creating a font reminiscent of the Bauhaus movement, but more similar to its predecessor, the style Braun's design, created Dieter Rams. This comparison is made even more obvious by comparing the typeface to Braun's logo by Wolfgang Schmitt (1952), both using a similar grid-based design with uniform curves. This geometric precision enhances the typeface's legibility, making it particularly suited for display purposes.

Ardua leans into the theme of play by introducing a unique variable crossbar. This allows the designer to play, edit and adjust the typeface to fit into any

of speakers from various backgrounds. Furthermore, this dynamic aspect makes it uniquely suited for motion graphics, instigating a spark of life into what otherwise could be an uninspiring design. Additionally, the



read in large sizes and to be used as for an impactful title or heading. The heavy weight of the lettering, along with the tall cap height and decorative elements, effects its legibility when used in body copy and as such, not recommended for it.

Within the V0X Classification system (1964), Ardua falls under a lineal geometric typeface as it is a sans serif font with a

Ardua 48pt CSBR 0

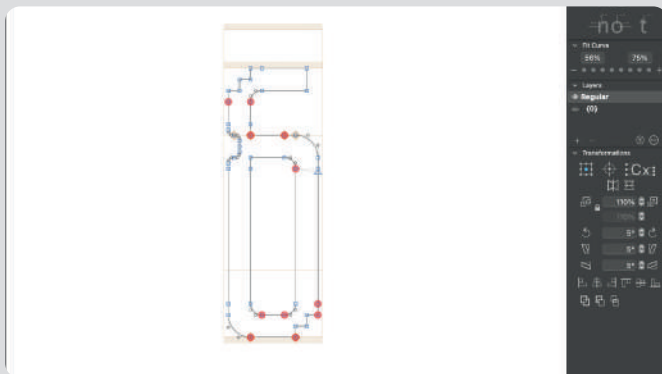
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VWXYZ

Ardua 48pt CSBR 50

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Ardua 48pt CSBR 100

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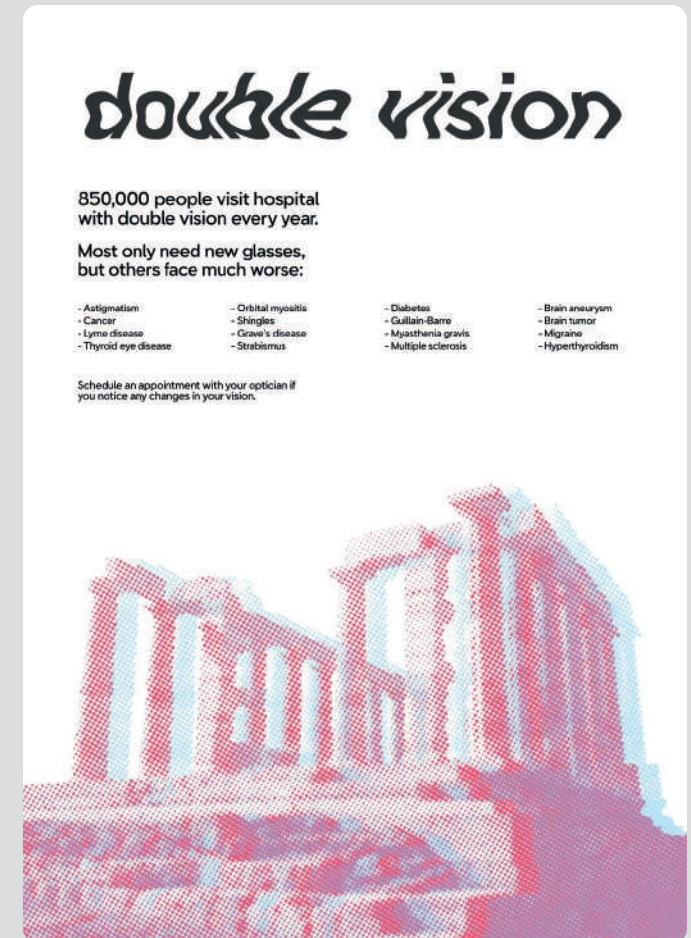
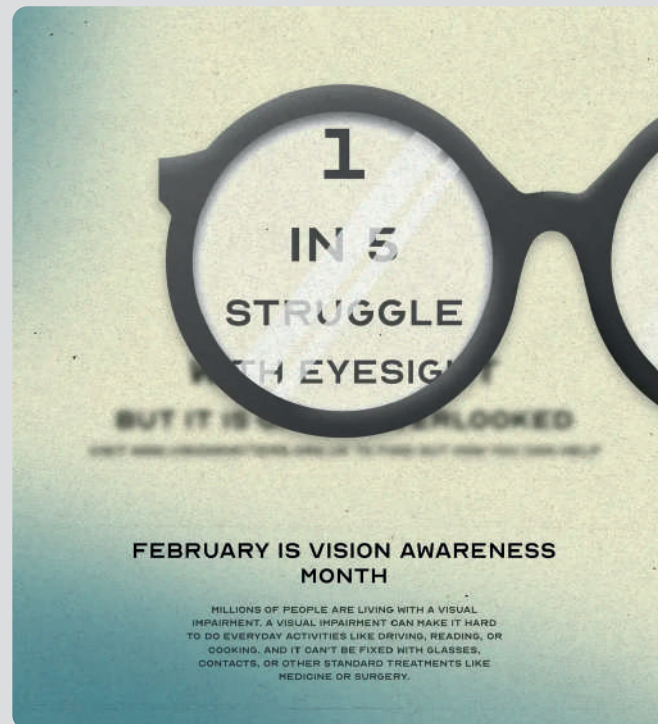
Inclusive Design

Over a year and a half, I looked at how design can be more inclusive for people with visual impairments. Based on my own experiences with colour blindness and poor depth perception, I wanted to explore how everyday visuals like signs and artwork affect those with sight loss.

I began by focusing on visual impairments, especially colour blindness, and how many people don't even realise they have it. I explored how these conditions are diagnosed and how we can raise awareness to encourage regular eye tests through the creation of posters in a variety of different styles to target specific demographics.

I conducted extensive research amongst my peers, as well as those working within the industry, to create engaging and accurate visuals.

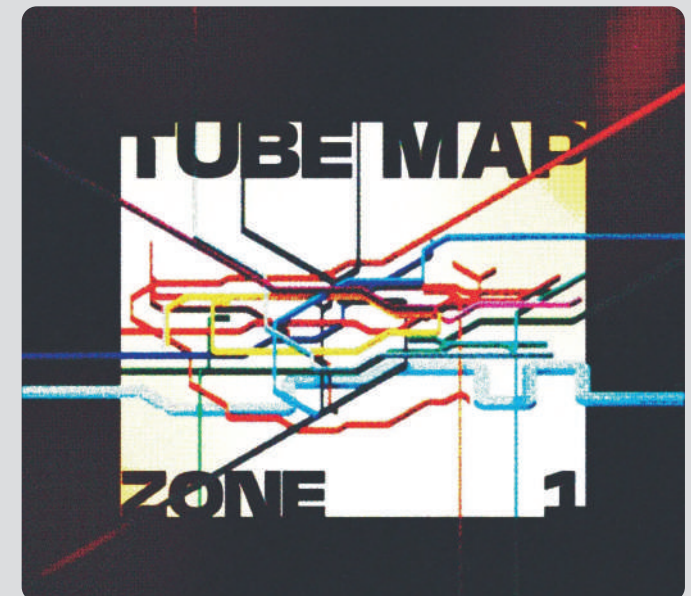
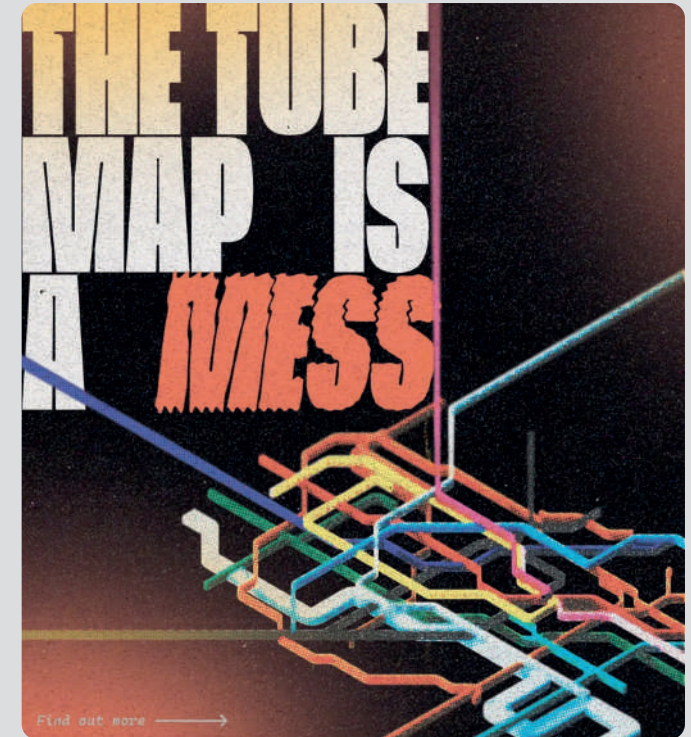
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The second part looks at real world examples of design, analysing what makes them effective/their short comings. I looked at road signs, creating a short pamphlet breaking down its successes, as well as the London Underground and its issues with accessibility.

The final outcomes include posters, infographics, and merchandise graphics that raise awareness and promote accessibility.



Fruitful

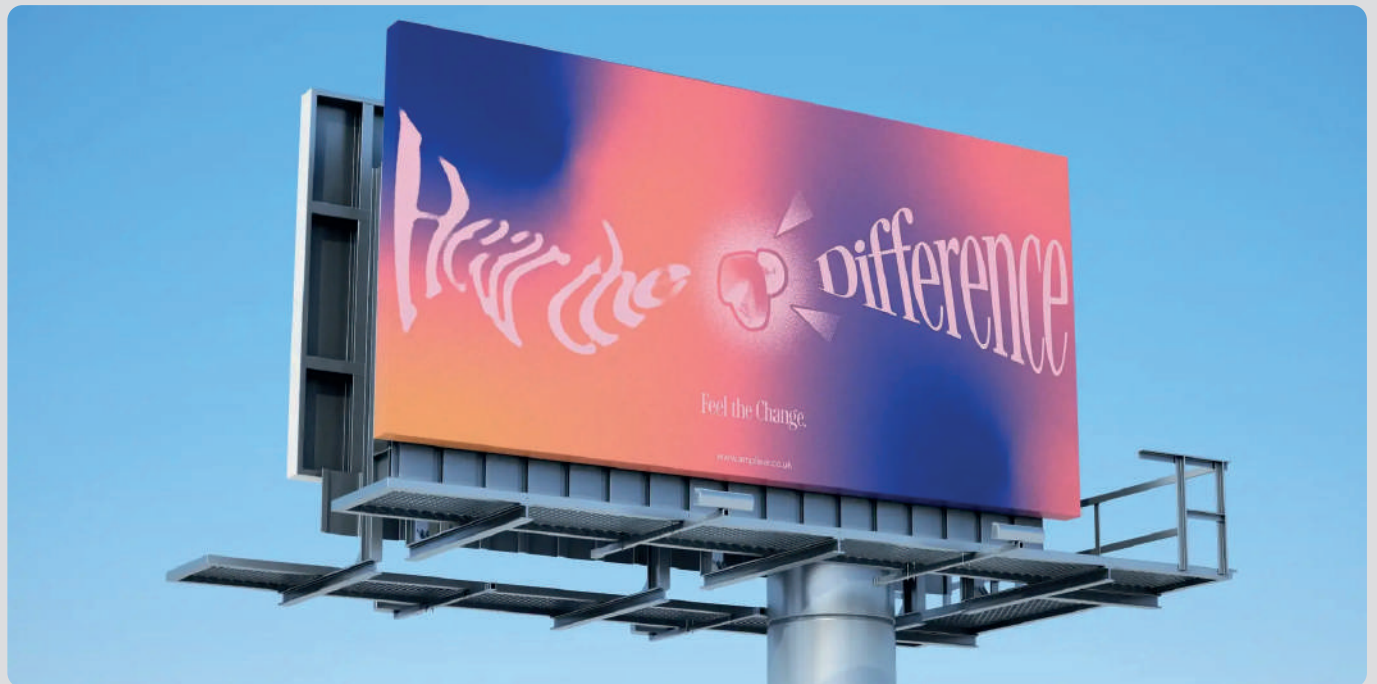
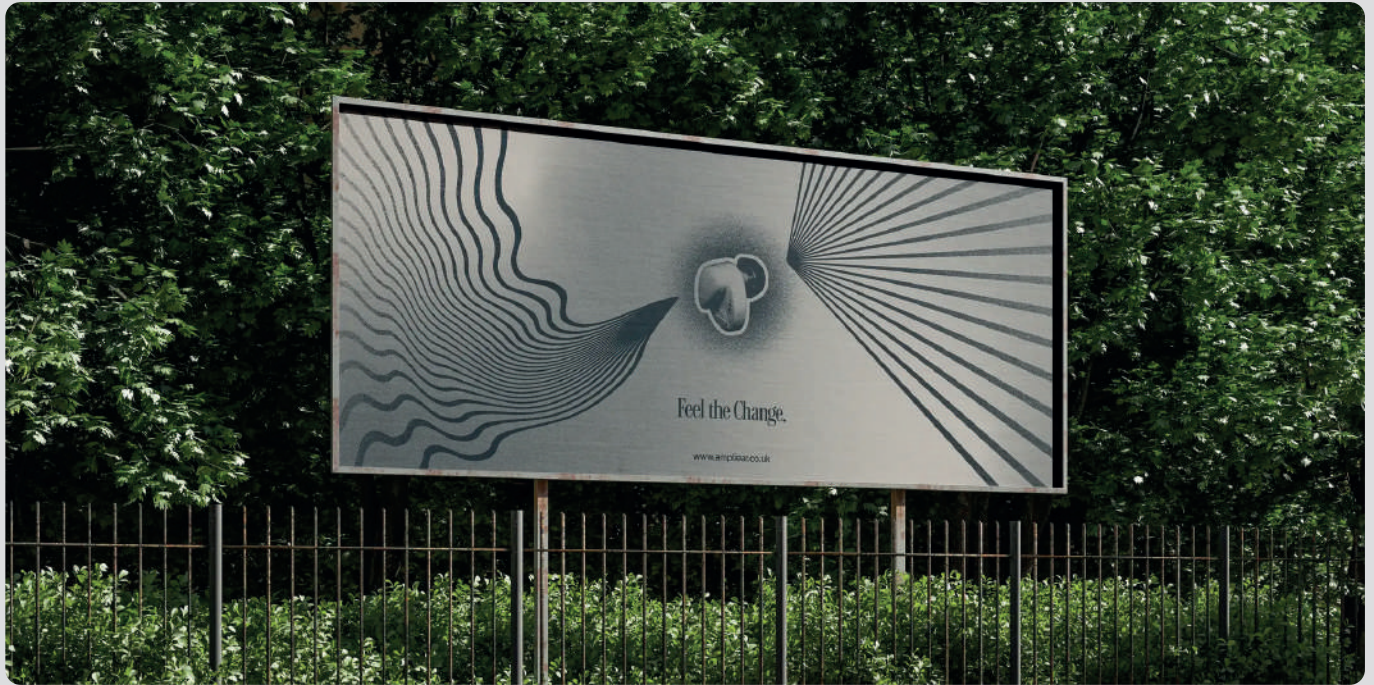
This project explores the concept of flavourings through the creation of a fictional fruit tea brand, Fruitful Tea Co. The brand was designed to feel both playful and professional, with a focus on bold, eye-catching visuals and a modern identity.

The project includes packaging design, promotional materials, and a website for the subscription-based delivery service. Branding was kept consistent through the development of clear guidelines, applied across posters, web design, and product mockups. The aim was to create a recognisable and engaging presence that could stand out in a crowded market.



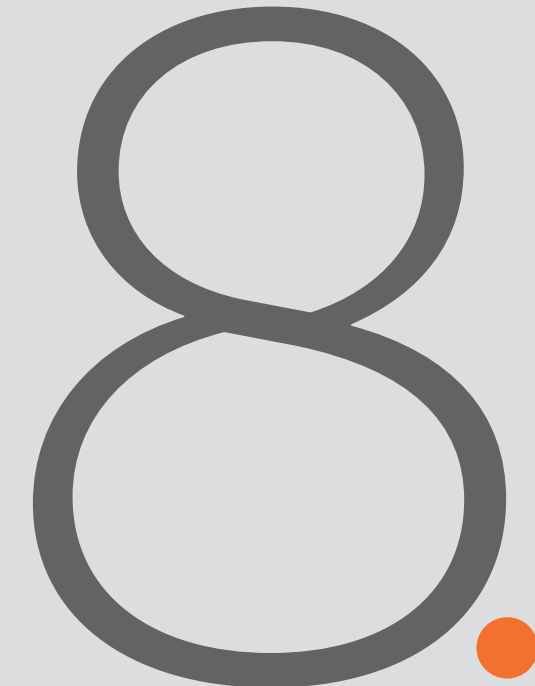
Ampliear

I worked on a campaign to show how Ampliear hearing aids make sound clearer. Using research and design experiments, I created posters and mockups with retro-tech visuals and simple distortion effects to highlight the shift from muffled to clear sound. The final pieces included billboard concepts with the line "Hear the Difference, Feel the Change."



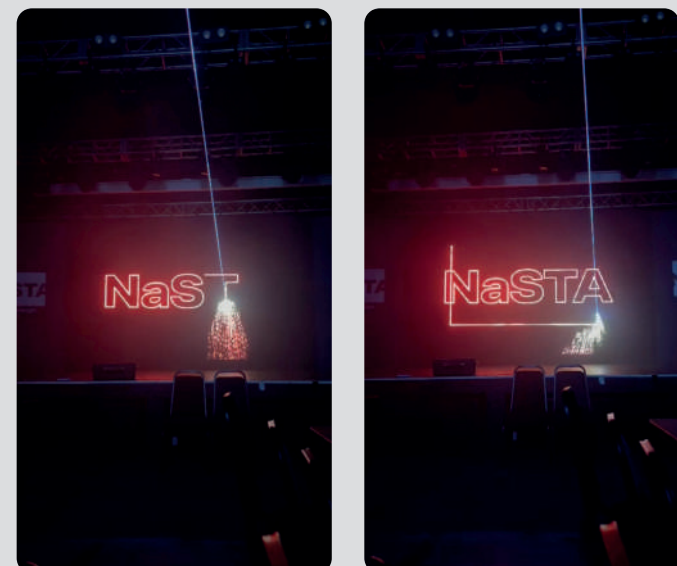
During my time within LSU Media, I undertook a variety of roles which often required me to make graphics for a wide range of mediums. I've worked with the editors of the LABEL Magazine to create a handful of spreads on different topics, creating engaging and visually coherent designs.

As well as this, as the Technical Officer, I also created some posters to help teach new members the various different types of cables. My latest project with media involved creating the opening sequence for the National Student Television Awards, a synced visual with immersive laser effects, visuals and sound design. The the sequence was celebrated multiple times by the hosts, and various judges, including Chris Cook, the Creative Director of BBC News. You can see the final video on my website: <https://willb.cc/project/nasta-intro>



A handy little chart full of common cable types used within Media. Have a question or is something missing? Let me know at willbaker@tsu.co.uk!

	(VIDEO) HDMI Digital cable carrying video and audio in one connection. Common on cameras, projectors, presentation laptops, and capture devices. located in placeholder		(VIDEO) SDI Digital cable carrying video and audio in one connection. Common on cameras, projectors, presentation laptops, and capture devices. located in placeholder		
	(VIDEO) Component Older video format with separate red, green, and blue connectors. Still found on older camera equipment. located in placeholder		(POWER) IEC Standard power cable used on PCs, monitors, recorders, and studio equipment. Very common across a wide range of devices/power supplies. located in placeholder		
	(POWER) 13A Standard UK mains plug. Powers most of our equipment. Often seen with a different connector on the end, or as an extender (or gang). located in placeholder		(POWER) 16A Higher-rated industrial/event power connector, often used in venues or outside spaces. located in placeholder		
	(POWER) Powercon A locking male connector for event power. Used for stage lighting, PA racks, and within a lot of rack-mounted equipment. Can sometimes be taken "out" of equipment to power multiple devices. located in placeholder		(POWER) Figure 8 Two-pin power lead for lower power devices. Common on small media players and some power supplies. located in placeholder		
	(POWER) 12V DC Barrel Jack Low-voltage power for cameras, and small devices. Often used on portable rigs or battery-powered setups. located in placeholder		(POWER) Micro USB Small connector for powering or updating portable devices. Used primarily on the microcameras. located in placeholder		



LSU Graphics

Produced digital and print design across campaigns, events, and student initiatives, including event branding, posters, signage, and social media stories. Designed fast-turnaround content for channels reaching 25k+ followers, balancing clear messaging with bold visuals to engage a diverse student audience. Collaborated closely with the Students' Union team to adapt designs across multiple touchpoints and ensure consistency both online and on campus.

I also developed lighting and club visuals for the SU club, creating complex node graphs to allow the visuals to be automated when less experienced techs were working. More information about this, along with videos can be found on my website: <https://willb.cc/project/su-club>

